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ANI

SISODIA ARREST

CAPITAL FETTERS

By Kaushik Deka

The arrest of Manish Sisodia, the most high-profile minister in Delhi chief minister Arvind Kejriwal's cabinet, is perhaps the biggest political crisis to hit the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) since its inception in 2012. The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) arrested the Delhi deputy CM on February 26 for alleged corruption in the formulation and implementation of the now-scrapped liquor excise policy of 2021-22. The agency alleges that Sisodia, as excise minister, took "arbitrary and unilateral decisions" causing "huge financial losses to the exchequer" and benefiting private players.

AAP, refuting the charges, accuses the Narendra Modi government of using the CBI for political vendetta. Sisodia is the second minister in Kejriwal's cabinet to be arrested by a central agency. Last June, the Enforcement Directorate (ED) arrested Satyendar Jain, another heavyweight minister, in an alleged money-laundering case. He has been in jail since; Sisodia, in his own words, may be behind bars for 6-7 months too. Both ministers have tendered their resignations. Sisodia is also being probed by the CBI for allegedly setting up a 'feedback unit' to collect political intelligence against AAP's